Expressing wishes and ambitions

Goal: To express wishes, hopes, dreams and ambitions with the right structures (*I wish, I hope, I would like to, I dream of, My ambition is to*) and to write a short paragraph about your future career.

The idea in two lines: A hope is something possible that you want to happen; a wish is often something unreal or difficult; an ambition is a strong goal you work towards. Each expression has its own grammar after it (infinitive with *to*, gerund, or a clause).

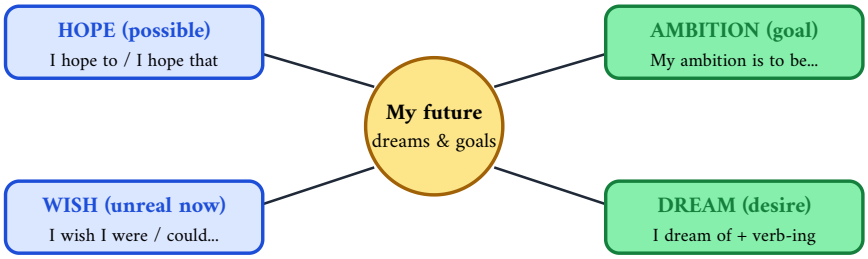


Figure 1: Mind map of the four ways to talk about the future you want, with the structure that follows each one.

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **I hope to + base verb / I hope (that) + clause:** a realistic wish for the future. *I hope to become a vet. I hope that I will pass the BEM.*
2. **I would like to / I'd like to + base verb:** a polite desire. *I'd like to study architecture.* Stronger: *I'd love to.*
3. **I wish + past simple / could:** a wish about something that is not true now. *I wish I were taller. I wish I could fly.* (same logic as conditional type 2)
4. **I dream of + verb-ing / noun:** *She dreams of becoming a famous singer.* Also: *My dream is to + base verb.*
5. **My ambition / goal / aim is to + base verb:** *My ambition is to open a hospital in my town.* Also: *I want to / I plan to / I intend to.*

6. **Useful vocabulary:** career, profession, achieve, succeed, reach a goal, make a dream come true.
7. In a paragraph about your future, combine these expressions with *will / going to* and connectors (*first, then, because*).

🟢 Examples

1. Complete: *Yacine wants to be a footballer but he is short. He says: "I wish I ..... (be) taller."* **Solution:** I wish I **were** taller. **Explanation:** the situation is unreal now, so *wish* + past simple.
2. Join the ideas: *Houda / dream / travel to Japan.* **Solution:** Houda dreams **of travelling** to Japan. / Houda's dream is **to travel** to Japan.
3. Write two sentences about your ambition. **Model answer:** My ambition is to become a computer engineer. I hope to study at a good university, so I'm going to work hard this year.

🟠 Common BEM mistakes

- *I hope become a doctor* ✗ → *I hope to become* ✓.
- *I wish I will be rich* ✗ → *I wish I were rich* ✓ (use *hope* for future possibilities, *wish* for unreal ones).
- *I dream to travel* ✗ → *I dream of travelling* ✓ or *My dream is to travel* ✓.
- Forgetting *to* after *would like*: *I'd like be* ✗.

🟡 Quick review

- hope to + verb / hope that + clause (possible).
- wish + past simple / could (unreal now).
- would like to / would love to + verb.
- dream of + verb-ing; my dream / ambition is to + verb.
- Plan: want to, intend to, going to.